

Erik T.J. Andersen

www.erik-tj-andersen.com

September 2026

Contact Information

Department of Economics
University of Washington
319C Savery Hall Chelan Ln
Seattle, WA, 98195

Email: eander46@uw.edu

Phone: (415) 497 9136

Education

2027 (Expected) Ph.D., Economics, University of Washington
Fields: Development Economics, Economics of Education,
Applied Microeconomics

2024 M.A., Economics, University of Washington

2022 M.S., Economics, University of Oregon

2021 B.S., Economics, University of Oregon
Minor in Mathematics
Summa Cum Laude, Phi Beta Kappa, Honors in Economics

Working Papers

“How to Build a Reader: Evidence from a Scalable Literacy Intervention in Ghana” with Simon Graffy, Jason Kerwin, and Monica Lambon-Quayefio. February 2026 [[World Bank WPS11433](#)] [[Ungated Preprint](#)]

Selected Work in Progress

No Longer Business as Usual: Evidence from Two Literacy Interventions in Ghana

Almost all evidence on education programs comes from settings where the counterfactual is business-as-usual schooling. As effective instruction scales, the policy question becomes what a program adds on top of it. I run a randomized trial in 103 Ghanaian schools already implementing an effective structured pedagogy program, testing two additional sources of learning: parents and principals. Schools received (i) restructured parent meetings plus take-home copies of the literacy workbook used in class, (ii) instructional leadership training for principals, (iii) both, or (iv) neither. The parent program raises reading fluency by 0.33 standard deviations, while the principal training lowers reading comprehension by 0.26 standard deviations. Combined, the parent program offsets part of the comprehension loss caused by the principal program. I show this is consistent with concave literacy production: the marginal return for parent engagement increases when instruction quality drops, so families invest more time in at-home learning.

Is Awareness Always Good? An Accidental Information Intervention in Nigeria

Cocoa no More: Evidence from Illegal Small-holder Gold Mining in Ghana

Why Cluster at all? Randomization Inference Correction to Incorrect Rejection Rates with Small Clusters

External Grants (\$855,101)

- 2026 J-PAL Learning for All Initiative (LAI) – \$113,160
“Government-Led Scaling of Tools for Foundational Learning Improvement (TFLI) in Ghana” (with Jason Kerwin, Simon Gaffy, Monica Lambon-Quayefio)
- 2026 J-PAL Learning for All Initiative (LAI) – \$34,040
“Turning Parents into Learning Partners: Testing the Complementarity Between Home and School Investments in Ghana”
- 2025 CEGA Development Economics Challenge Grant – \$ 12,000
“Turning Parents into Learning Partners: Testing the Complementarity Between Home and School Investments in Ghana”
- 2024 J-PAL Learning for All Initiative (LAI) – \$400,000
“Integrating Educational Technology with Structured Pedagogy to Improve Learning Outcomes for Every Student” (with Jason Kerwin, Simon Gaffy, Monica Lambon-Quayefio)
- 2024 IPA Partnerships for Tech in Education (P4T-ed) – \$295,901
“Integrating Educational Technology with Structured Pedagogy to Improve Learning Outcomes for Every Student” (with Jason Kerwin, Simon Gaffy, Monica Lambon-Quayefio)

Fellowships and Awards

- 2026 Buechel Memorial Scholarship
- 2022 Provost Richards’ Fund for Graduate Students

Invited Presentations (Including Scheduled)

- 2026 Comparative & International Education Society (CIES); Funds for Innovation in Development (FID); NBER Education Program Meeting (Presenter: Jason Kerwin); Ghana Education Evidence and Data Lab (GEEDLab)
- 2025 Inspiring Teachers; Gates Foundation Global Education; Prevail Fund; Sonoma State University

Invited Workshops (Including Scheduled)

- 2026 Western Economic Association International’s Graduate Student Workshop

Consulting Positions

- 2026 Research Consultant, Allan & Gill Gray Philanthropy Africa: Data-SMARTS

Teaching

Instructor, Department of Economics, UW

2025- ECON 300: Intermediate Microeconomics
2024- ECON 200: Introduction to Microeconomics
2024- ECON 201: Introduction to Macroeconomics

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, UW

2023-2024 ECON 200: Introduction to Microeconomics
2023-2026 ECON 201: Introduction to Macroeconomics

Teaching Assistant Coordinator, Department of Economics, UW

2025-2026 ECON 200: Introduction to Microeconomics
2025-2026 ECON 201: Introduction to Macroeconomics

Professional Service

Journal Referee

Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization

Department Service

2022- Graduate Student Committee President

Skills

Programming: R, SQL, Stata, L^AT_EX, Matlab, Mathematica, BASH

References

Jason Kerwin (Chair)

Associate Professor of Economics
University of Washington
jkerwin@uw.edu

Isabelle Cohen

Assistant Professor of Economics
University of Washington
imcohen@uw.edu

Rachel Heath

Alberta C. Corkery Professor of Economics
University of Washington
rmheath@uw.edu